THE NO YOU OWE

Practical Tools & Workbook

Kel Mosi

> *These tools are not extras. They are where the transformation actually happens. Read the book. Then return here and do the work.*

How to Use This Workbook

Each tool in this section is tied directly to a chapter. Use them in order — they build on each other the same way the chapters do. You won't get the full benefit of Tool 5 if you haven't done the work in Tools 1 through 4.

Print this workbook if you can. Writing by hand slows your brain down in a useful way. But if you prefer to type, that works too. What matters is that you actually fill it in — not just read it and nod.

Start with Tool 1 before you read Chapter 1. Take the Self-Assessment Quiz now — it takes five minutes and gives you a baseline score. You'll take it again after 30 days. The shift in your score is your evidence. Then work through the tools in order as you read each chapter. The Guilt Audit can be used any time guilt shows up. The Relationship Map needs updating every few months as people and dynamics change.

Tool	Tied to Chapter
Tool 1 — Self-Assessment Quiz	Take before Chapter 1 and again after 30 days
Tool 2 — The Pre-Response Checklist	Chapter 1: The 3-Second Pause Protocol
Tool 3 — The Guilt Audit Worksheet	Chapter 2: The Guilt Audit System
Tool 4 — The Boundary Ladder Tracker	Chapter 3: Build Your No Muscle
Tool 5 — The Relationship Triage Map	Chapter 4: Know Where to Start
Tool 6 — The Self-Promise Tracker	Chapter 5: Keep Promises to Yourself
Tool 7 — The 5-Minute Daily Check-In	Conclusion: Maintenance

TOOL 1

Self-Assessment: Where Are You Starting From?

Take this quiz right now, before you read further. Be honest with yourself — no one else will see this. When you finish the book, come back and take it again. The shift in your score is your evidence.

For each statement, write a number from 1 to 5 in the space provided:

Score	1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

Section A: Reflexive Yes-Saying

Statement	Score
I say yes within seconds of being asked, before I've had a chance to think.	
I check my calendar after I've already agreed to something.	
I have committed to things I immediately regretted.	
I find it hard to ask for time before giving an answer.	
I say yes even when I know I don't have the time or energy.	
Section A: Reflexive Yes-Saying Total:	

Section B: Guilt & Obligation

Statement	Score
I feel crushing guilt when I say no, even to unreasonable requests.	
I cannot tell the difference between real guilt and manipulated guilt.	
I feel responsible for other people's feelings and reactions.	
I believe other people's needs are more important than mine.	
When someone is disappointed in me, I feel like a bad person.	
Section B: Guilt & Obligation Total:	

Section C: Boundary Avoidance

Statement	Score
I avoid setting boundaries because I am afraid of conflict.	
I over-explain and over-apologize when I do say no.	
I have never set a firm boundary with my closest family members.	
I freeze when it comes to actually speaking a boundary out loud.	
I would rather suffer quietly than risk disappointing someone.	
Section C: Boundary Avoidance Total:	

Section D: Relationship Imbalance

Statement	Score
I give far more in most relationships than I receive.	
I am everyone's helper but I rarely ask for help myself.	
Some people in my life only contact me when they need something.	
I stay in draining relationships because I feel obligated.	
I am not sure who my truly safe people are.	
Section D: Relationship Imbalance Total:	

Section E: Self-Abandonment

Statement	Score
My personal goals have been on hold for months or years.	
I rarely protect time for rest on my calendar.	
I break promises to myself but keep every promise to others.	
I don't believe my needs deserve the same priority as others'.	
I have lost touch with what I actually want because I'm so focused on others.	
Section E: Self-Abandonment Total:	

OVERALL TOTAL (add all five sections):

What Your Score Means

Score	Pattern	What It Means
100–125	**Severe**	You're in full self-abandonment mode. Every chapter is essential. Start at Chapter 1 and work through in order. You'll see real change within 30 days if you do the exercises.
75–99	**Significant**	You regularly sacrifice your needs and have weak boundaries in most relationships. You know you should set boundaries but guilt stops you. This book gives you the system you've been missing.
50–74	**Moderate**	You can say no in some areas but struggle in close relationships. The Relationship Triage Map in Chapter 4 will be particularly eye-opening for you.
25–49	**Mild**	You have decent boundaries overall but specific situations or people still trip you up. Use the tools to shore up those weak spots.
0–24	**Minimal**	You're already reasonably strong at prioritizing yourself. These tools can help you maintain and refine. Consider using them for specific areas where you still feel friction.

Which Section Scored Highest?

Your highest-scoring section points directly to your biggest struggle area. That chapter deserves extra attention from you.

Section	Your Biggest Struggle	Focus Chapter
A	Reflexive yes-saying	Chapter 1: The Pause Protocol
B	Guilt and obligation	Chapter 2: The Guilt Audit
C	Boundary avoidance	Chapter 3: The Boundary Ladder
D	Relationship imbalance	Chapter 4: Relationship Triage
E	Self-abandonment	Chapter 5: The Self-Promise Tracker

Come Back in 30 Days

Date taken (first time):

Total score:

Date taken (second time):

Total score:

Change:

What shifted most:

TOOL 2
The Pre-Response Checklist

For Chapter 1 — Use before answering any request.

> *A note on how to use this tool before you begin. The 3-Question Filter — capacity, priorities, desire versus obligation — is your real-time tool. Three questions, answered quickly, in the moment or close to it. That is what you reach for when someone is waiting for a response and you have used your pause script to buy yourself a thinking window. This checklist is your reference document. It is the fuller version of the process — eight steps rather than three questions — designed to be worked through carefully when you are learning the system, when a request is complex or high-stakes, or when you want to audit a decision you already made. You do not need to run through all eight steps every time someone asks if you want coffee. You do need them when your manager asks you to take on a project that will consume your next three months, or when a family member makes a request that has guilt and history and relational weight attached to it. Use the Filter in the moment. Use the Checklist to go deep.*

Step 1: Pause First

□ I used my pause script before responding. "Let me check and get back to you by [time]."

My pause script:

Step 2: Understand the Request

□ I know exactly what is being asked of me.
□ I know how much time it will actually require.
□ I know when it is needed and what's involved.

Step 3: Check Your Actual Capacity

□ I've looked at my real calendar — not just imagined it.
□ I have time and energy without depleting myself.
□ This request does not conflict with my three self-promises (Rest, Progress, Connection).

Step 4: Run the 3-Question Filter

□ Do I have the actual capacity for this? (Not 'could I squeeze it in' — do I genuinely have room?)
□ Does this align with my current priorities?
□ Am I saying yes out of genuine desire, or obligation? (If obligation: the answer is no.)

Step 5: Audit Any Guilt (if present)

□ I've checked whether this guilt is real or fake. (See Tool 3.)
□ My decision is based on capacity and values, not fear of disappointment.

Step 6: Triage the Relationship

Note: The full Relationship Triage system is introduced in Chapter 4 / Tool 5. If you are using this checklist during Chapter 1, use your instinct for now: does this feel like a give-and-take relationship, or primarily one-directional? You will map it properly when you reach Chapter 4.

This person is a:

☐ **Nurturer**	☐ **Transactional**	☐ **Complicated**	☐ **Drainer**

(See Tool 5 for the full Relationship Triage Map.)

Step 7: Make Your Decision

☐ **Full Yes** *I genuinely want to and have capacity.*	☐ **Modified Yes** *I can do [specific part] but not the full ask.*	☐ **No** *I don't have capacity or it's not aligned.*

Step 8: Respond by Your Promised Time

☐ I responded within the timeframe I gave.

If yes: "I can help with [specific thing]. Here is what works for me: [your terms]."
If no: "I'm not able to take this on. I hope you find someone."
If modified: "I can do [X] but not [Y]. Would that work?"

> *A note on guilt after saying no: If the guilt comes flooding back once you've responded, go to Tool 3. Run the audit. Remind yourself: the guilt was checked. It's fake. Let it move through you without acting on it.*

TOOL 3
The Guilt Audit Worksheet

For Chapter 2 — Use any time guilt shows up around a boundary.

> *This worksheet can be used again and again. You don't need a fresh copy each time — a notebook works just as well. What matters is that you write it down rather than just thinking it. Anxious brains loop. Writing forces clarity.*

What Triggered the Guilt? Describe the situation briefly:

What Is the Guilt Voice Saying? Write down the exact thought (for example: "You're being selfish," "They need you," "A good person would help"):

The 3-Question Guilt Test

Answer each question as honestly as you can.

Question 1: Did I violate my own values — or just someone else's expectations?

My core values (honesty, reliability, kindness, etc.):

- ☐ I violated my own values. (Explain below.)
- ☐ I violated their expectations, but not my values.

Question 2: Would I judge a close friend harshly for making this same choice?

- ☐ Yes, I would think they were wrong. (If yes — this guilt may be real. Move carefully.)
- ☐ No, I'd say 'good for you' and mean it. (If no — this guilt is almost certainly fake.)

Question 3: Is this guilt proportional to the actual harm caused?

The actual, concrete harm I caused:

- ☐ My guilt matches the harm. (Proportional.)
- ☐ My guilt is far bigger than the harm. (Disproportionate — a strong sign it's fake.)

Where Does This Guilt Belong?

Based on your answers, place this guilt in one of the four categories:

☐ **Real & Actionable** *You actually violated your values. Apologize and make amends.*	☐ **Real & Unactionable** *You made the best choice with difficult tradeoffs. Acknowledge it and move forward.*
☐ **Fake & External** *Someone is using your guilt against you. Hold your boundary. Do not reward manipulation.*	☐ **Fake & Internal** *Your detector is misfiring. Challenge the thought. Let the feeling pass without acting on it.*

What Will You Do?

- ☐ Change my boundary (Only if guilt is Real & Actionable.)
- ☐ Hold my boundary (For all other categories.)

What I'm reminding myself:

After the Dust Settles

Come back and fill this in once the situation has resolved.

Did the disaster I feared actually happen?

What actually happened?

What did I learn?

> *Most people-pleasers discover that 80–90% of their guilt is fake. That's not a small thing. That is a lifetime of pain caused by a miscalibrated detector. You are not wrong for setting boundaries. You were just never taught to question the alarm.*

TOOL 4
The Boundary Ladder Tracker

For Chapter 3 — Log each boundary as you set it. Do not skip rungs.

> *Your brain will try to minimize your wins ("that was nothing") and catastrophize your fears ("this will destroy everything"). This log is the antidote. It creates objective evidence that your nervous system can't argue with.*

Rung 1 — Micro-No to Strangers

Goal: 3 completed. People you'll never see again. The word "no" is not a grenade.

Entry 1

What I said no to:

What I feared would happen:

What actually happened:

Entry 2

What I said no to:

What I feared would happen:

What actually happened:

Entry 3

What I said no to:

What I feared would happen:

What actually happened:

Rung 2 — Preference-No to Service Providers

Goal: 2 completed. Practice advocating for what you actually want.

Entry 1

What I advocated for:

What I feared would happen:

What actually happened:

Entry 2

What I advocated for:

What I feared would happen:

What actually happened:

Rung 3 — Calendar-No to Acquaintances

Goal: 2 completed. Your time is yours. Protecting it is not rudeness.

Entry 1

Who asked, and for what:

What I said:

What actually happened:

Entry 2

Who asked, and for what:

What I said:

What actually happened:

Rung 4 — Boundary-No to Friends

Goal: 2 completed. Real friendships survive honesty. If this one doesn't, that tells you something important.

Entry 1

The boundary I set:

How they responded:

Did I use the broken record if they pushed back?

How I felt afterward:

Entry 2

The boundary I set:

How they responded:

Did I use the broken record if they pushed back?

How I felt afterward:

Rung 5 — Values-No to Family

Goal: 1 completed. Only attempt after finishing Rungs 1–4. Love does not require self-erasure.

Entry 1

The boundary I set:

What I threatened and then followed through on:

Did I need to use the broken record?

How they responded:

How I felt afterward:

After the Ladder — Full Reflection

> *Take a moment here. You have set boundaries with strangers, professionals, acquaintances, friends, and family. That is not a small thing. Read back your Rung 1 entry. Does it feel easy now? That distance between then and now — that is growth. You did that.*

What percentage of my feared outcomes actually happened?

Most people discover it's less than ten percent. Your brain's predictions are not reliable forecasts. They are threat responses. There is a difference.

Which rung was hardest, and why?

Usually it's Rung 4 or 5 — the people who matter most feel the scariest. That's not a flaw. It's evidence that you care about those relationships.

Which rung was easiest, and does that surprise you?

Did I need to use the broken record? What happened when I did?

What surprised me most across the whole ladder?

Which boundary am I most proud of? Why?

What boundary do I still need to set that the ladder didn't reach?

What will I do differently when I face pushback in the future?

> *Save this log. On the days when the guilt is loud and the old patterns pull hard, read it. I've done this before. I can do it again.*

TOOL 5
The Relationship Triage Map

For Chapter 4 — Complete after Chapter 3. Revisit every 3 months.

> *This map is private. Be honest. You are not cutting people off by naming the truth about a relationship — you are finally seeing it clearly enough to respond wisely.*

The Four Categories — Quick Reference

Nurturers	Transactionals	Complicated	Drainers
Reciprocal, safe, respectful of your boundaries. Invest freely here.	Functional and fine when kept in their lane. Polite, clear boundaries.	You love them AND they cause you stress. Firm boundaries with compassion.	Consistently extract. May manipulate. Rigid boundaries or distance.

Nurturers — Invest freely here

#	Name / Initials	Evidence for this category	One action step
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
8.			

Transactionals — Polite, clear boundaries

#	Name / Initials	Evidence for this category	One action step
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
8.			

Complicated — Firm boundaries with warmth

#	Name / Initials	Evidence for this category	One action step
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			

6.			
7.			
8.			

Drainers — Protect yourself here

#	Name / Initials	Evidence for this category	One action step
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
8.			

Where Is Your Energy Mismatched?

Answer these questions after you've filled in the map above.

Where am I over-investing? (Giving Nurturer energy to Transactionals or Drainers) — Names and what I'm doing:

What I'll change:

Where am I under-receiving? (Keeping Nurturers at arm's length) — Names:

What I'll practice:

Where do I need stronger boundaries? (Complicated or Drainers I'm still overextending for) — Names:

The boundary I need to set:

Your One Action Per Category — This Week

> *Chapter 4 ends with a specific instruction: take one action with each category this week. Use this page to commit to those actions before you close the book.*

Nurturers — Ask for something

Ask a Nurturer for help, time, or support — something real. Practice receiving.

Who I will ask:

What I will ask for:

When I will do it:

Transactionals — Say no in one sentence

No explanation. One sentence. Practice brevity.

The request I'll decline:

My one-sentence no:

Complicated — Set the one key boundary

Identify the single boundary that would most change this dynamic. Set it this week.

The person:

The boundary I will set:

When and how I will set it:

Drainers — Create distance

One concrete step: fewer responses, shorter interactions, or a boundary you've been avoiding.

The person:

The specific step I will take:

What If the Map Throws Up Hard Cases?

> *Some situations don't fit cleanly into four categories. Use the prompts below if you hit any of them. Write honestly — these are the questions that tend to point at the most important work.*

What if most of my people land in Complicated or Drainer? Have I set clear, consistent boundaries with these people and had them violated — or have I never set clear boundaries at all, and am categorising based on feeling rather than evidence? What does that tell me?

What if I have no Nurturers? What does that tell me about how I've been showing up in relationships — or about who I've been allowing close? What is one thing I could do differently?

What if the person in my Drainer category is someone I can't simply distance from — a partner, a parent I see regularly, a co-parent? What is the most realistic boundary or change available to me right now?

> *If there is any element of abuse in a relationship — emotional, physical, financial, or otherwise — please do not navigate this alone. The framework in this book is not designed for abusive dynamics. A therapist, a domestic abuse organisation, or a trusted professional is a better guide than any workbook page.*

Revisit this map every three months. People don't stay in the same category forever. Your Complicated relationships may move toward Nurturer if they respond to your boundaries. Some Drainers may reveal themselves more clearly over time. Update accordingly.

TOOL 6
The Self-Promise Tracker

For Chapter 5 — Fill in at the start of each week. Review every Sunday.

> *Your self-promises are not extras. They are the point. Rest, Progress, and Connection — blocked in your calendar before anyone else gets access to your time. If it isn't scheduled, it isn't protected.*

Before You Begin: Define Your Three Promises

What does each promise mean specifically to you? Vague intentions don't get kept. Concrete commitments do.

REST means (be specific — sleep, solitary time, a walk, no screens):

PROGRESS means (the goal, project, or skill you are protecting time for):

CONNECTION means (which people, what kind of contact):

Week 1

Week of: _____

Promise	Scheduled?	Protected?	Kept?
Rest	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Progress	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Connection	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No

Week 1 score (promises kept out of 3):

If I didn't keep a promise, what happened?

What will I do differently next week?

Week 2

Week of:

Promise	Scheduled?	Protected?	Kept?
Rest	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Progress	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Connection	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No

Week 2 score (promises kept out of 3):

If I didn't keep a promise, what happened?

What will I do differently next week?

Week 3

Week of:

Promise	Scheduled?	Protected?	Kept?
Rest	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Progress	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Connection	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No

Week 3 score (promises kept out of 3):

If I didn't keep a promise, what happened?

What will I do differently next week?

Week 4

Week of:

Promise	Scheduled?	Protected?	Kept?
Rest	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Progress	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No
Connection	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Fully ☐ Partly ☐ No

Week 4 score (promises kept out of 3):

If I didn't keep a promise, what happened?

What will I do differently next week?

After 30 Days — Reflection

Total promises kept out of 12:

Which promise was hardest to protect, and why?

What tangible progress have I made on my Progress promise?

How do I feel now compared to 30 days ago?

> *Every kept promise is a brick in the foundation of self-trust. You are not just getting better at saying no to others. You are learning to say yes to yourself and mean it.*

A Note on Continuing Beyond Thirty Days

This tracker covers four weeks. The practice it supports does not end there.

If you have reached the end of Week 4 and kept most of your promises, you have established something real: a baseline of self-trust that did not exist a month ago. The work now is to maintain it, not to declare it complete.

The simplest way to continue is to replicate this tracker in a notebook — the same three promises, the same three columns, the same Sunday reflection. You do not need a printed form. You need the habit of checking in with yourself once a week and asking: did I show up for myself this week? If yes, what made that possible? If not, what got in the way?

The maintenance schedule in the Conclusion gives you the broader rhythm — daily check-in, weekly review, monthly guilt audit, quarterly relationship retriage, annual ladder refresh. The Self-Promise Tracker is the weekly heartbeat of that schedule. Five minutes on a Sunday. A question and an honest answer.

Some people find it useful to retake the Self-Assessment Quiz from Tool 1 every three to six months — not to measure progress against a number but to see which sections have shifted and which haven't. The sections that remain stubbornly high after several months of practice are usually pointing at something specific: a relationship that still needs a boundary, a self-promise that keeps getting sacrificed, a guilt pattern that hasn't fully been addressed. Use that information. It is the system still working for you.

You do not need a new workbook for any of this. You need a notebook, a pen, and the decision to keep going.

TOOL 7
The 5-Minute Daily Check-In

For the Conclusion — Use every morning or evening to keep the practice alive.

> *This is maintenance, not extra work. Five minutes each day is the difference between an eight-week transformation and a permanent one. Use the morning version to prepare, the evening version to reflect. Or just pick one and stick with it.*

Morning Version — Before the Day Begins

Use this to step into the day with intention rather than reaction.

1. Review your calendar.

- ☐ My three self-promises are blocked for today.
- ☐ I know which people or situations may require a boundary today.

2. Prepare for likely requests.

Who might ask me for something today?

My pause script if they do:

---

3. Set your intention.

Today I will practice: (check one)

- ☐ Using the pause before saying yes
- ☐ Auditing my guilt in real time
- ☐ Saying no without over-explaining
- ☐ Protecting my self-promise time
- ☐ Asking a Nurturer for help

Other:

---

4. Read this aloud.

> *I can feel guilt and still hold my boundaries. My needs are not negotiable. I am allowed to prioritize myself.*

Evening Version — Before the Day Ends

Use this to close the loop, learn from slips, and prepare for tomorrow.

1. Did I keep my self-promises today?

- ☐ Rest: protected.
- ☐ Progress: showed up for it.
- ☐ Connection: prioritized it.

2. Celebrate a win.

Even small ones count. Name one thing you did today that your past self would not have done.

Today I:

---

3. Learn from any slips.

If you caved to guilt or broke a boundary today, treat it as data — not failure.

What happened?

What will I do differently tomorrow?

---

4. Prepare for tomorrow.

Tomorrow's biggest likely challenge:

My plan:

---

5. Read this aloud.

> *I did my best today. I am learning. Progress, not perfection. Tomorrow I begin again.*

A Note on Maintenance

Boundaries are not a project with a finish line. They are a practice, like any other form of wellbeing. The people who hold their boundaries over the long term are not the ones who worked hardest for eight weeks and then stopped. They are the ones who made five minutes of daily reflection a permanent habit.

You have the tools now. You have the evidence. The only thing left is to keep going.

The no you owe is to yourself.

You have earned it. Now go live like you believe it.